Voice Research Findings — Narrator for Explorer Pipeline Video (Ages 8-14)

Key Research Findings

1. Female Voice Preference — 66% (Caryn Clark / Yoto / Disney Research)

- **66% of video viewers prefer female voices over male**
- Associated traits: friendliness, trustworthiness, approachability
- Especially important for children who **respond to energy and tone more than content itself**
- Female voiceover artists excel at conveying warmth and approachability
- Source: Caryn Clark, VOICECHICK PRODUCTIONS (LinkedIn, Dec 2024)

2. Children's Educational Game Voice Best Practices

- **Speak clearly** — educational component requires clarity
- **High energy, upbeat delivery** — transforms passive listening into active engagement
- **Playful tones and dynamic energy** — children naturally drawn to these
- **Animated delivery paired with empathetic tone** — creates memorable bridge
- **Enchantment over manipulation** — Guy Kawasaki principle: "delighting people"
- Source: suchavoice.com, Caryn Clark

3. Multimedia Learning Voice Effect (Academic Research)

- **Human voice > computer voice** for learning outcomes (Dinçer, 2022, cited 16x)

- Voice principle: people learn better with human voice in multimedia instruction
- Gender matching effect exists but is secondary to energy/warmth
- Emotional tone (happy) significantly improves learning vs neutral/sad (Zhao, 2023, cited 13x)
- Source: ERIC, PsycNET, ScienceDirect

4. K-Pop / Anime Style for Youth Engagement

- K-Pop Demon Hunters (2025-2026) — animated series integrating Korean pop culture with supernatural narrative
- Five key engagement themes identified (Park, 2026): parasocial relationships, cultural identity, community
- Anime as educational tool: visual complexity + narrative depth = deeper interest in learning (Dery, 2024)
- Bright colors, catchy beats, animated styles designed to capture attention from kids and teens
- Source: MDPI, Ashesi University, Media Education Lab

Recommendation: THE VOICE

Based on all research, the optimal voice for the Explorer Pipeline video (ages 8-14) is:

Energetic Young Female — "K-Pop Guide" Style

Characteristics:

1. **Female** — 66% preference, warmth, trustworthiness
2. **Young-sounding** (20s) — relatable to 8-14 age group, not maternal
3. **High energy** — upbeat, dynamic, animated delivery
4. **Clear diction** — educational clarity requirement
5. **Playful but not childish** — respects the intelligence of the audience
6. **Slight anime/K-pop cadence** — rhythmic, punchy, with dramatic pauses for emphasis
7. **Happy emotional tone** — proven to improve learning outcomes

The voice should feel like an **excited older sister or cool young teacher** who genuinely thinks this stuff is amazing — not a corporate narrator, not a children's TV presenter, not a parent. Think: the voice that introduces a new K-pop group member, or the narrator of a shonen anime explaining a power-up. Energetic, clear, slightly breathless with excitement, punchy delivery.

This maps directly to what Nigel suggested: "a kpop demon type exciting voice that's female"

Voice Generation Approach

- Use AI TTS with female voice, young, energetic
- Script should use short punchy sentences
- Include dramatic pauses and emphasis markers
- Rhythm: fast-slow-fast pattern (anime pacing)